TOEFL iBT

## Overview

| 項目 | 托福新制 | |
|---|---|---|
| 測驗設計 | 閱讀/聽力採多階段適性測驗 | |
| 考題內容 | 真實學術情境, 跨文化設計 | |
| 分數呈現 | 同現 0–120 分制; 1–6 級分; CEFR 等級 | |
| 出分速度 | 最快 72 小時內 | |
| 在家測驗監考 | ETS 官方訓練專員 + AI 驗證 | |
| 聽力<br>~47 題 \| ~29 分鐘 | Single Question<br>Multiple Questions<br>(2~4) | 聆聽句子 Best Response<br>對話（生活情境）Conversation<br>公告 Announcement<br>學術講座 Lecture |
| 口說<br>11 題 \| 8 分鐘 | P1. Listen and Repeat<br>P2. Take an Interview | 跟讀句子 7 句<br>面試式問答 4 題 |

## Google Drive

## Conversation 1

1 What is the main purpose of the conversation?
(A) To complain about local traffic conditions
(B) To arrange a new time for a study meeting
(C) To discuss the contents of a calculus exam
(D) To explain the results of a chemistry lab

2 Which part of the subject matter is the woman finding difficult?
(A) Memorizing specific formulas
(B) Understanding integration topics
(C) Completing the practice exam
(D) Applying calculus to lab work

3 What will the man likely do if his lab does not finish on schedule?
(A) Reschedule the session for Friday
(B) Go directly to the student lounge
(C) Send a message to the woman
(D) Ask the woman to start without him

**Script:**

W: Hi, I'm so sorry I missed our tutoring session yesterday. My bus was stuck in traffic for almost an hour because of the construction on Main Street.
M: No worries, I figured something came up. Since we have that big calculus exam on Friday, do you still want to go over the practice problems?
W: I really need to. **I'm having trouble with the integration sections. Is there any way we could meet tomorrow afternoon instead?**
M: Actually, I have a lab until four, but I could meet you in the student lounge right after that. Does that work for you?
W: That sounds great! I'll bring the textbooks. Why don't you let me know if your lab runs late?
M: Will do. Just make sure to review the formulas before we meet so we can save some time.
W: Good idea. That's a relief, I was really worried about falling behind.

**Conversation 2**

1 What is the man's primary concern?
(A) His difficulty with a morning class
(B) The cost of living in a dormitory
(C) A technical issue with a website
(D) A conflict with his current roommate

2 What does the woman suggest the man do next?
(A) Look for information online
(B) Create a new study schedule
(C) Speak with a campus counselor
(D) Visit the dorm office in person

3 What will the man likely do after his seminar?
(A) Talk to his roommate
(B) Submit a housing form
(C) Check a deadline
(D) Go to his sleep lab

**Script:**
W: I noticed the dorm office was really crowded this morning. Are you trying to switch rooms for next semester too?
M: Actually, I was. **I'm having trouble getting any sleep because my roommate stays up late playing video games.**
W: That's disappointing. Have you tried talking to him about a quiet-hours agreement first? Sometimes a simple conversation works.
M: I did, but he hasn't really changed his habits. I'm worried it's going to affect my grades since I have early morning labs.
W: I see. Well, why don't you check the residence hall website? They just posted the deadline for room-change requests.
M: That sounds great. I'll do that right after my seminar. Thanks for the tip.

## Announcement 1

1 What is the main purpose of the announcement?
(A) To announce a change in studio rules
(B) To promote a weekend music concert
(C) To advertise a new communication course
(D) To recruit students for a radio team

2 What does the speaker advise students to do this Wednesday?
(A) Listen to the music broadcast
(B) Sign up for a soundboard workshop
(C) Submit a resume to the studio
(D) Attend an open house event

3 What information will students receive during the studio visit?
(A) Details about the instruction for new members
(B) The history of the broadcasting team
(C) A list of available musical recordings
(D) The schedule for the upcoming semester

**Script:**

M: Hello everyone! **This year, we'll be expanding our broadcasting team and we are looking for dedicated students to join us.** Our popular weekend music show is back this year with a brand-new format, and we need hosts, technical assistants, and content researchers. This is a wonderful opportunity to develop your communication skills while building a professional portfolio. **Make sure to visit our studio in the student union building this Wednesday for an open house. We'll provide a short tour and explain the training process, including how to operate the soundboard.** We hope you all can participate and help us share great music with the campus community.

**Announcement 2**

1 What is the main topic of the announcement?
(A) A recruitment for a school band
(B) An upcoming charity concert
(C) A change in the event schedule
(D) A new library opening

2 What is the purpose of the event?
(A) To buy books for the library
(B) To train students in technology
(C) To celebrate the end of the year
(D) To promote local musicians

3 What tasks will the student volunteers perform?
(A) Manage booths and equipment
(B) Perform on the main stage
(C) Organize library book shelves
(D) Write articles for the website

**Script:**
W: **Next week, we'll be launching our very first Benefit Concert for Literacy right here on the main quad. This year, we'll be featuring several local bands to help raise money for new books at the community library. We are currently searching for enthusiastic students to help manage the ticket booths and assist with technical equipment during the performances.** Volunteering is a fantastic way to gain event management experience while supporting a worthy cause. Make sure to visit our website to register for a shift, including your contact information and availability. We hope you all can join us for a night of great music and give back to our community!

## Academic Vocabulary

| Word | Example Sentence |
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| Word | Example Sentence |
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## Lecture 4

1 What is the lecture mainly about?
(A) The search for precious metals in the 1900s
(B) Unique characteristics and lessons from Barringer Crater
(C) The discovery of various types of limestone
(D) The history of nuclear testing in Arizona

2 What can be inferred about the regional limestone before the meteor hit?
(A) It already contained some structural weaknesses or patterns.
(B) It was softer than the limestone found in other states.
(C) It had been heavily mined for iron by previous inhabitants.
(D) It was once located at the bottom of a nuclear test zone.

3 The speaker brings up the kinetic energy of cosmic objects in order to:
(A) Argue that the Arizona crater is larger than once thought
(B) Clarify how iron meteorites can be harvested easily
(C) Illustrate the underlying cause of the crater's features
(D) Highlight the differences between planets and moons

4 Which of the following is NOT discussed as a factor that makes the crater a 'vital laboratory'?
(A) Patterns in how the regional rocks shattered
(B) The chemical composition of the limestone joints
(C) Information for the field of planetary defense
(D) The study of kinetic energy in collisions

### Script:

Barringer Crater in Arizona is one of the best-preserved impact sites on our planet. What makes this site distinctive is its nearly perfect square shape, which was caused by pre-existing joints in the regional limestone that shattered along specific lines during the impact. Equally remarkable is the physical evidence found within the crater, such as 'shocked quartz.' These are tiny grains of sand that have been permanently changed by the intense pressure of the meteor hitting the ground. You won't find this type of mineral structure anywhere else except at nuclear test sites or other impact zones. Another significant aspect is the economic history of the site. In the early 1900s, an engineer named Daniel Barringer spent decades drilling into the floor of the crater, convinced he would find a massive iron meteorite worth a fortune. He didn't realize that most of the meteor had actually vaporized upon impact. *These elements converge in the study of planetary defense today. By looking at how the rocks shattered and how much energy was released*, scientists can better predict what might happen if another large object hits Earth. **This combination of factors—the unique shape, the rare minerals, and the failed mining attempts—makes the crater a vital laboratory for understanding the violent history of our solar system. It highlights the incredible power of kinetic energy when cosmic objects collide with a rocky surface.**

Lecture 8

1 What is the lecture mainly about?
(A) The formation and significance of the Giant's Causeway
(B) The engineering techniques used to build basalt bridges
(C) The history of volcanic eruptions in Northern Ireland
(D) A comparison between modern geology and ancient folklore

2 What can be inferred about the cooling rate of the lava at the Giant's Causeway?
(A) Speed was essential for the creation of the cracks
(B) It cooled faster than the rock underneath it
(C) Atmospheric pressure slowed the cooling process
(D) It stayed liquid for thousands of years

3 What is the purpose of discussing the giant named Finn MacCool?
(A) To highlight the poetic interpretation of natural events
(B) To explain why the rock formations look artificial
(C) To provide evidence of human construction at the site
(D) To debate the historical accuracy of Irish folklore

4 Which of the following is NOT discussed as a reason for the site's importance?
(A) Its role in the local tourism economy
(B) Its value as a case study for volcanology
(C) Its use in building modern infrastructure
(D) Its contribution to cultural storytelling

Script:

**The Giant's Causeway is a geological wonder situated on the northern coast of Northern Ireland. What makes this site distinctive is the presence of approximately forty thousand interlocking basalt columns, which resulted from ancient volcanic eruptions approximately sixty million years ago.** These columns predominantly feature hexagonal shapes, creating a geometric pattern that appears almost artificial. Equally remarkable is the engineering of the cooling process that produced these structures. **As the thick plateau of molten lava cooled rapidly, it contracted and cracked, following a physical principle known as columnar jointing.** This process is similar to how mud cracks when it dries, but on a massive, crystalline scale. Another significant aspect is the site's rich cultural history, as *local legends attributed the formation to the construction of a bridge* by a giant named Finn MacCool. These elements converge in the modern designation of the site as a UNESCO World Heritage area, where physical science and mythology intersect. This combination of factors ensures that the *Giant's Causeway remains an essential case study for volcanology* while *simultaneously supporting a thriving local tourism economy*. **Collectively, these features provide profound insight into the thermal dynamics of the Earth's crust and the poetic ways in which humanity interprets natural phenomena.** This site demonstrates that geological history is not merely a record of physical events but also a foundation for cultural identity.

## Lecture 3

1 What is the main topic of the talk?
(A) The use of Lidar technology in geological mapping
(B) The history of Pacific Northwest urban planning
(C) The preservation of dense forest vegetation
(D) The development of traditional aerial photography

2 What can be inferred about traditional aerial photos in forested areas?
(A) They are no longer used by any modern geologists
(B) They are more detailed than Lidar images of the ground
(C) They cannot capture the terrain beneath the trees
(D) They are more expensive to produce than Lidar maps

3 What does the speaker say about the processing of Lidar data?
(A) It is limited by the number of airplanes available
(B) It is faster than analyzing traditional aerial images
(C) It is often performed by geologists while in the field
(D) It requires significant time and computational resources

4 Which of the following is NOT mentioned as a drawback or requirement of Lidar?
(A) High financial costs
(B) Need for high-tech sensors
(C) The necessity of walking the ground
(D) Massive data processing needs

### Script:

**Today, we're going to talk about the concept of Lidar, which stands for Light Detection and Ranging. Lidar refers to a remote sensing technology that uses laser pulses to create very detailed 3D maps of the Earth's surface.** This has gained traction because it can 'see' through dense vegetation. In the past, if geologists wanted to map a fault line in a thick forest, they had to walk every inch of the ground, and even then, they might miss something hidden by trees. The benefit is that Lidar allows us to strip away the digital image of the forest canopy to reveal the bare ground underneath. **This has led to the discovery of hidden fault lines and ancient landslides that were completely invisible on traditional aerial photos.** For example, in the Pacific Northwest, Lidar revealed several dangerous faults near major cities that no one knew existed. On the other hand, Lidar data is incredibly expensive to collect and requires specialized airplanes and high-tech sensors. **Processing the massive amount of data also takes a long time and a lot of computing power, which can be a barrier for smaller research teams.** This balance between the high cost and the incredible precision it provides is the main challenge for modern geological surveys. Despite the expense, the technology is becoming the new standard for assessing natural hazards. It has fundamentally changed our ability to identify risks that were once concealed by the natural landscape.

Lecture 2

1 What is the main topic of the talk?
(A) The discovery of subduction zones
(B) The mechanism of plate tectonics
(C) The history of GPS technology in geology
(D) An evaluation of the Expanding Earth theory

2 What does the speaker state about the Earth's radius based on a 2011 study?
(A) It is not undergoing any meaningful increase in size.
(B) It varies depending on the accuracy of GPS satellite data.
(C) It is contracting slightly due to tectonic plate movement.
(D) It is expanding at a rate of several millimeters per year.

3 The speaker mentions a semi-liquid mantle in order to:
(A) Clarify the original source of the Earth's heat
(B) Support the idea of a constant planetary volume
(C) Highlight a flaw in the 2011 GPS study
(D) Show how expansion effects the Earth's interior

4 Based on the lecture, what can be inferred about the scientific community's view of the Expanding Earth theory prior to modern satellite data?
(A) It was immediately dismissed as a decorative map theory.
(B) It was favored over the theory of subduction zones.
(C) It was abandoned because the gravitational constant changed.
(D) It was considered a viable explanation for continental movement.

Script:

The Expanding Earth is a theory that suggests the position and movement of the continents are the result of the entire planet increasing in volume over time. The traditional explanation involves the idea that the Earth’s radius was once much smaller, and as the globe grew, the crust broke apart into the continents we see today. This was long attributed to unknown internal energy sources or changes in the gravitational constant. Proponents argued this explained why the continental coastlines fit together so perfectly like puzzle pieces. More recent studies, however, have disputed the claim that the Earth is getting any larger. Scientists now use high-precision satellite data and GPS measurements to track the movement of the Earth's crust with millimeter accuracy. **A 2011 study found that the Earth's radius is not actually changing by any significant amount, certainly not enough to account for continental drift. Instead, the evidence strongly supports the theory of plate tectonics, where the Earth's size remains constant while the plates move over a semi-liquid mantle.** This suggests that while the Expanding Earth idea was a creative way to explain the map of our world before we understood subduction zones, it doesn't hold up under modern physical testing. **It serves as a reminder that even aesthetically pleasing theories must be discarded when they conflict with measurable data.**

## Lecture 5

1 What is the main topic of the talk?
(A) The historical expansion of the Earth's crust
(B) The chemical composition of modern silicates
(C) The geological process of the Iron Catastrophe
(D) The discovery of radioactive decay in minerals

2 What can be inferred about the Earth before the Iron Catastrophe?
(A) It was already fully layered and stable
(B) It was primarily composed of liquid water
(C) It was much larger than it is today
(D) It did not yet have a clearly defined metallic core

3 The speaker states that the 2021 study led to what conclusion?
(A) The core was formed much faster than imagined
(B) Radioactive decay stopped during the transition
(C) The planet's differentiation happened over several stages
(D) The Earth reached a state of stability immediately

4 The speaker brings up the 2021 study in order to...
(A) Explain the exact chemical sequence of metal melting
(B) Prove that the traditional Iron Catastrophe theory is entirely wrong
(C) Show how new evidence can refine our timeline of planetary history
(D) Suggest that the Earth's core is larger than previously thought

### Script:

**The Iron Catastrophe is a theory that describes a major event during the early formation of Earth, occurring approximately fifty million years after the planet first coalesced.** The traditional explanation involves the gradual melting of the planet due to radioactive decay and intense gravitational pressure. This was long attributed to a sudden internal shift where heavier molten metals, primarily iron and nickel, migrated toward the center while lighter silicate minerals rose to the surface. **This massive reorganization eventually created Earth's layered structure, consisting of a dense metallic core and a rocky mantle.** More recent studies, however, have disputed the claim that this was a singular, rapid event. **A 2021 study found that the separation of metal from silicate might have occurred in multiple stages across much longer periods than previously hypothesized.** This research suggests that the differentiation was likely influenced by frequent massive impacts from other celestial bodies, which repeatedly remelted the crust and delayed the stabilization of the core. This suggests that the interior of our planet remained in a state of flux significantly longer than the original 'catastrophe' model implies. **This shift in perspective obliges geologists to reconsider the cooling rate of the early Earth and the timing of the first magnetic field.** Such findings underscore the dynamic nature of planetary evolution, reminding us that even the stable ground beneath our feet was once a site of unimaginable thermal chaos.

## Lecture 7

1 What is the main topic of the talk?
(A) The comparison of different diamond-tipped tools
(B) The invention of industrial gemstone cutting
(C) The chemical composition of diamonds and glass
(D) The history and application of the Mohs scale

2 What can be inferred about the tools required for the Mohs scale?
(A) They are more expensive than modern electronic equipment
(B) They require a supply of diamonds to test soft minerals
(C) They must be replaced after every single test
(D) They are portable and easy to use outside of a lab

3 According to the speaker, what difficulty did mineralogists face before the Mohs scale?
(A) The lack of any minerals harder than glass
(B) An inability to transport laboratory equipment to the field
(C) A global shortage of diamonds for testing purposes
(D) A reliance on subjective and unorganized descriptions

4 Which of the following is NOT mentioned as a current use for the Mohs scale?
(A) Practical field identification of specimens
(B) Introductory geology education
(C) The industrial gemstone industry
(D) Building microscopic electronic circuits

### Script:

You are probably familiar with the concept of mineral hardness, specifically the idea that a diamond can scratch glass. Its origins trace back to the early nineteenth century when Friedrich Mohs, a German mineralogist, sought to create a standardized system for identifying minerals based on their physical properties. A defining characteristic is the ordinal nature of the scale, which ranks ten minerals from softest, talc, to hardest, diamond. Unlike absolute scales that measure precise pressure, the Mohs scale is relative; it determines whether one substance can visibly scratch another. **The turning point came when the scale was adopted globally as a field-testing standard because it required no expensive laboratory equipment—only a set of reference minerals.** By the mid-1900s, it had become the foundational tool for geologists working in remote locations, *allowing for rapid identification of specimens through simple scratch tests.* **Today, it continues to be integral to both introductory geology education and the industrial gemstone industry.** While modern scientists now utilize more precise methods, such as the Vicker's or Knoop tests which use diamond-tipped instruments to measure indentation, the simplicity of the Mohs scale remains unsurpassed for practical application. **It transformed mineralogy from a collection of subjective descriptions into an organized, comparative science.** Historically, this system was the very first step toward modern materials science, proving that the structural integrity of natural substances could be categorized through systematic observation and physical interaction.

## Lecture 6

1 What is the main topic of the talk?
(A) The geological process of columnar jointing
(B) The chemical composition of basaltic lava
(C) The history of volcanic eruptions in ancient times
(D) The impact of climate change on rock formations

2 What can be inferred about the interior of the lava flow during the early stages of the process?
(A) It contains different chemical elements than the surface.
(B) It is under less pressure than the atmosphere.
(C) It remains fluid while the outer layer has already hardened.
(D) It cools more rapidly than the surface layer.

3 The speaker states that columnar jointing is useful to geologists because it allows them to:
(A) Predict when the next volcanic eruption will occur
(B) Map the exact path the lava took across the land
(C) Identify the mineral content of the original magma
(D) Determine the cooling speed of prehistoric lava

### Script:

The mechanism works as follows: when a thick layer of basaltic lava begins to cool, it undergoes a unique thermal contraction that results in the formation of geometric columns. **This process begins when the surface of the lava flow cools and solidifies, while the interior remains molten and extremely hot.** As the heat eventually dissipates, the cooling rock shrinks in volume, creating a network of internal stresses. What enables this is the principle of maximum efficiency; the rock cracks in a hexagonal pattern because that shape releases the most tension with the least amount of energy. The sequence involves these cracks propagating downward from the surface into the cooling mass, forming long, vertical pillars that are perfectly joined. **This is crucial because these formations, known as columnar jointing, provide geologists with significant data** regarding the cooling rate and thickness of ancient volcanic events. **By measuring the width of the columns, researchers can calculate exactly how quickly the lava lost its heat millions of years ago.** However, these spectacular structures face a threat from physical weathering. Water frequently enters the joints between the columns, and *during freeze-thaw cycles, the expanding ice forces the pillars apart*, leading to dramatic rockfalls and the eventual destruction of the formation. Such erosion highlights the temporary nature of even the most solid geological features. This reminds us that the earth's crust is in a constant state of transition, where creative volcanic forces are perpetually balanced by the destructive power of the elements.

## Speaking Task 1

### Set 1: Car Rental Agency

*You are being trained to assist customers at a car rental agency.*

**1** Welcome, let's check your reservations.

**2** You can choose your vehicle from this lot.

**3** The rental terms can be viewed at the contract signing desk.

**4** When you are ready, come over to the key pickup station.

**5** Over here is where rental cars are returned to the parking lot.

**6** Please be sure to make a full inspection before driving away from the building.

**7** When returning your vehicle, park it in the same spot you picked it up from.

### Set 2: Community Center

*You are being trained to help visitors at a community center.*

**1** Welcome to the community center.

**2** Go to the information desk for help.

**3** The activity rooms hold various classes daily.

**4** The gym is where our popular fitness programs are held.

**5** We recommend a visit to the café for a snack or drink.

**6** We have a notice board for updates on community events and important announcements.

**7** If you're interested in learning more about our new courses, pick up a free flyer.

# Speaking Task 2

## Set 1: Government and Public Services

*You have volunteered for a research study about government services and basic public procedures. You will have a short online interview with a researcher. The researcher will ask you some questions.*

**Q1:** Thank you for participating today. I'd like to ask you some questions about government services. First, have you or someone you know ever had to deal with a complicated government process, such as applying for a document or registering for a service? What was the experience like?

**Q2:** Great. When you need to complete government tasks, such as renewing an ID or filing paperwork, do you prefer handling everything online or by mail, or do you like going to an office and dealing with a person face to face? Why?

**Q3:** Interesting. Some people say government forms should be simplified, even if that means collecting less detailed information. Do you agree or disagree? Why or why not?

**Q4:** Good points. Lastly, some places are introducing digital IDs that people can keep on their phones instead of carrying physical cards. Do you think this is a positive development, or do you think physical IDs should remain the standard? Explain your answer.

## Set 1: Interview Aids

### Q1: Thank you for participating today. I'd like to ask you some questions about government services. First, have you or some

**Brainstorming Table:**

| Answer Angle | $ (Money) | Time | Ppl (Connection) | Extra (Skill/Health) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Negative experience: Burdensome and inefficient bureaucracy | Hidden costs of repeated document notarization fees; lost wages from taking unpaid leave to visit offices during work hours; transportation expenses for multiple return trips. | Months-long waiting periods for simple approvals; hours spent standing in physical queues; time wasted correcting minor clerical errors made by staff. | Frustrating interactions with indifferent clerks; tension at home caused by the stress of pending legal status; lack of clear communication channels for help. | High cortisol levels and sleep loss due to anxiety; no new skills gained other than navigating redundant paperwork; feeling of helplessness against a rigid system. |
| Negative experience: Technological barriers and digital exclusion | Requirement to purchase expensive hardware or high-speed internet to access portals; fees for third-party 'consultants' who help navigate broken websites. | Hours spent troubleshooting 404 errors or non-functional upload buttons; delay in service delivery because of server crashes; time lost resetting forgotten passwords. | Isolation for elderly relatives who cannot use the interface; digital divide creating a gap between tech-savvy citizens and the marginalized; lack of human support. | Eye strain from staring at complex digital forms; decline in digital confidence after repeated failed attempts; mental fatigue from decoding technical jargon. |
| Positive experience: Efficiency through modern e-Government | Significant savings on fuel and parking; discounted 'early-bird' processing fees for online applications; no need to hire expensive legal representatives. | Instant submission of documents via mobile apps; 24/7 availability allowing for application at midnight; real-time tracking bar showing exactly when documents arrive. | Ability to share digital receipts instantly with family; online community forums where users share tips on filling forms; professional help via live chat agents. | Improved digital literacy and data management skills; reduced stress due to transparency; sense of empowerment and trust in the state's infrastructure. |
| Positive experience: High-quality in-person concierge service | Free on-site assistance that prevents costly filing mistakes; access to information about government grants or subsidies the user didn't know existed. | One-stop-shop centers that handle multiple permits in a single visit; fast-track appointments that respect the user's scheduled time slot. | Personalized guidance from knowledgeable civil servants; feeling like a valued citizen rather than a number; networking with other small business owners in the waiting lounge. | Learning the specific legal requirements of one's industry; peace of mind from receiving a physical, stamped confirmation; reduced cognitive load through guided steps. |

## Q2: Great. When you need to complete government tasks, such as renewing an ID or filing paperwork, do you prefer handling ev

**Brainstorming Table:**

| Answer Angle | $ (Money) | Time | Ppl (Connection) | Extra (Skill/Health) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Online/Mail (Focus: Efficiency and Convenience) | Eliminates commuting costs like gas, subway fares, or expensive downtown parking fees. Avoids taking unpaid time off work to visit offices during business hours. | Completing forms takes minutes rather than hours spent in physical waiting rooms. Digital systems allow 24/7 access so tasks fit around a personal schedule rather than government hours. | Reduces frustration from dealing with grumpy or overworked clerks. Minimizes physical contact in crowded waiting areas which prevents the spread of seasonal illnesses. | Develops digital literacy by navigating secure portals and uploading encrypted documents. Encourages organized record-keeping as digital receipts are harder to lose than paper slips. |
| Online/Mail (Focus: Accuracy and Documentation) | Digital systems flag errors immediately, preventing financial penalties for late or incorrect filings. Saves money on printing and postage by using paperless uploads. | Auto-fill features pull previous data to speed up the process. Instant confirmation emails provide immediate peace of mind without waiting for a mail carrier. | Removes the pressure of a line of people behind you, allowing you to read fine print carefully. Eliminates potential linguistic barriers or misunderstandings with office staff. | Reduces environmental impact by cutting down on paper waste and carbon emissions from travel. Promotes personal autonomy by allowing individuals to manage their own data directly. |
| In-Person (Focus: Troubleshooting and Resolution) | Saves money by getting the right information the first time, avoiding 'trial and error' application fees. Staff can often waive certain fees or suggest cheaper filing options. | Complex problems are solved in one sitting rather than through weeks of back-and-forth emails. Getting an ID printed on-site is faster than waiting 10 business days for mail delivery. | Real-time feedback from an expert ensures that nuanced questions about legal status or residency are answered accurately. Body language and tone help clarify confusing instructions. | Reduces the 'tech stress' and anxiety associated with website glitches or login failures. Provides a sense of security and closure that comes from handing documents directly to a human. |
| In-Person (Focus: Accessibility and Verification) | Beneficial for those who don't own expensive hardware like scanners or high-speed internet. Prevents identity theft costs by ensuring sensitive documents never enter the mail system. | Immediate physical verification of original birth certificates or passports prevents delays caused by document rejection. Staff can help navigate complex bureaucratic jargon quickly. | Supports community jobs by utilizing local government offices. Provides a necessary social touchpoint for elderly citizens or those who feel isolated by the 'digital-only' world. | Critical for people with disabilities who may need physical assistance or specialized equipment to complete forms. Ensures 100% accuracy for life-changing documents like passports or deeds. |

**Q3: Interesting. Some people say government forms should be simplified, even if that means collecting less detailed informat**

## Set 2: Volunteering and Community Service

*You have volunteered for a research study about community involvement. You will have a short online interview with a researcher. The researcher will ask you some questions.*

**Q1:** Thank you for speaking with me today. I'd like to ask you some questions about volunteering and community service. First, can you share one or two experiences you or someone you know has had with volunteering or helping in the community?

**Q2:** I see. Some volunteer programs are organized by large international organizations, while others are run by small local groups. Would the type of organization affect your willingness to volunteer? Why or why not?

**Q3:** Interesting. Some people believe that universities and high schools should require students to complete a certain number of volunteer hours in order to graduate. Do you think mandatory volunteering is a good strategy for building community? Why or why not?

**Q4:** Good points. Lastly, looking to the future, do you think the way people volunteer will change? For example, will more volunteering happen online, or will in-person community work remain the most important form? Explain your thoughts.

## Set 2: Interview Aids

### Q1: Thank you for speaking with me today. I'd like to ask you some questions about volunteering and community service. First

**Brainstorming Table:**

| Answer Angle | $ (Money) | Time | Ppl (Connection) | Extra (Skill/Health) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Positive: Professional Development Focus | Unpaid internships are replaced by high-value volunteer roles; networking with industry leaders at charity galas leads to lucrative job offers. | Committing 5 hours weekly to manage a non-profit's social media; balancing volunteer deadlines with university coursework to improve time-management. | Building a professional network of mentors; collaborating with diverse teams of experts that one wouldn't meet in an entry-level job. | Gaining hands-on experience with project management software; developing public speaking skills by pitching fundraising ideas to local businesses. |
| Positive: Emotional and Physical Health Focus | Reducing future healthcare costs through active lifestyle; saving money on gym memberships by doing physical labor like community gardening. | Scheduling 'digital detox' periods during weekend park cleanups; investing time into others which creates a 'time affluence' psychological effect. | Combating urban isolation by meeting neighbors; forming deep emotional bonds with elderly residents at nursing homes through weekly visits. | Lowering cortisol levels and blood pressure through altruistic acts; gaining a sense of purpose that mitigates symptoms of burnout or depression. |
| Negative: Financial and Resource Strain Focus | Hidden costs of transportation to remote service sites; potential loss of income from part-time jobs due to mandatory volunteer hours. | Long commutes to underprivileged areas taking up 10+ hours weekly; volunteering taking away from critical study time for professional certifications. | Strained relationships with family due to weekend absences; feeling social pressure to donate money one cannot afford during charity drives. | Physical exhaustion from labor-intensive roles like building houses; risk of 'compassion fatigue' and emotional drainage from high-stress environments. |
| Negative: Inefficiency and Lack of Impact Focus | Misallocation of donor funds toward administrative overhead instead of the cause; the high cost of training short-term volunteers who leave quickly. | Hours wasted on redundant clerical tasks that could be automated; slow progress on community projects due to lack of professional oversight. | Creating a 'savior complex' dynamic rather than equal partnership; superficial connections with community members who see volunteers come and go. | Volunteers performing tasks they aren't qualified for, such as amateur construction; lack of real-world skill growth due to the menial nature of assigned work. |